Cybersecurity Risk Assessment Report

Organisation: Bruges Retail Solutions (Fictional)
Assessment Type: Simulated Cybersecurity Risk Assessment
Prepared by: Joshua Van Wyk
Date: October 2026

1. Executive Summary

A simulated cybersecurity risk assessment was conducted for Bruges Retail Solutions, a fictional Belgian e-commerce company employing 40 people.

The assessment identified eight cybersecurity risks affecting the organisation's IT infrastructure, customer information and business operations.

Of the eight identified risks, five were classified as High and three as Medium. The highest-priority areas include phishing, ransomware, customer data breaches, e-commerce service disruption and unpatched systems.

The assessment recommends implementing appropriate security controls to reduce the likelihood of incidents, protect sensitive information and strengthen business continuity.

2. Assessment Scope & Methodology

The assessment covered the organisation's e-commerce platform, customer database, Microsoft 365 environment, employee devices, cloud storage and third-party service providers.

Risks were assessed using a qualitative 5×5 risk matrix, with likelihood and impact rated from 1 (lowest) to 5 (highest).

Risk Score = Likelihood × Impact

Risk classifications were defined as:

- Low: 1–5
- Medium: 6–14
- High: 15–25

Risk scores are provisional estimates based on a fictional business environment. Existing security controls were not independently verified.

3. Key Findings

Risk	Inherent Risk	Expected Residual Risk
Phishing & Account Compromise	16 — High	8 — Medium
Ransomware	15 — High	10 — Medium
Customer Data Breach	15 — High	10 — Medium
E-commerce Service Disruption	16 — High	8 — Medium
Unpatched Systems	16 — High	8 — Medium

The findings highlight risks to the confidentiality, integrity and availability of the organisation's information and services.

All five High risks were estimated to decrease to Medium following effective implementation of the recommended controls.

These residual scores are hypothetical estimates and do not represent verified improvements.

4. Risk Treatment Recommendations

The following measures are recommended:

Identity & Access Security: Enforce multifactor authentication, strengthen access controls and provide employee phishing awareness training.

Ransomware Protection: Implement endpoint protection, maintain secure backups and regularly test recovery procedures.

Customer Data Protection: Apply least-privilege access, encrypt sensitive data and conduct regular application security assessments.

Service Availability: Implement DDoS protection and website monitoring to reduce the likelihood of prolonged e-commerce disruption.

Vulnerability Management: Establish a formal patch management process and prioritise remediation of critical vulnerabilities.

Management should prioritise treatments based on risk severity, implementation costs and available resources.

5. Conclusion

The assessment identified several cybersecurity risks that could significantly affect Bruges Retail Solutions' operations, financial stability and customer trust.

Implementing the recommended security controls could reduce the organisation's exposure to these threats. However, cybersecurity risks cannot be eliminated entirely.

Management should review the proposed treatments, assign accountability, allocate appropriate resources and reassess residual risks after implementation.

Disclaimer: This report is based on a fictional organisation and hypothetical risk scenarios. It was prepared as an educational GRC portfolio project and does not represent a real-world security assessment.